

buy, be certain that the payments fit your budget.

Contrary to a popular belief among young couples, a house is not a “need.” At least not most of the houses we see around us. But I do believe God promises that if we trust Him, He will provide according to His will. If God’s plan for you is to have a home, there is a house out there sitting and waiting for you. The way to know it’s from God? It will always be within your budget. God will not put you in debt. As Proverbs 24:27 says, “Prepare your work outside, and make it ready for yourself in the field; afterwards, then, build your house.”

QUESTION 11. Should we have joint accounts?

We both work. When we’re married, should we have separate or joint checking accounts?

ANSWER: Let me encourage you to never maintain separate anything, including checking accounts. When you develop a his money/her money philosophy, it usually leads to a him-versus-her mentality. There should be no his money/her money in a marriage. The only reason to maintain a separate account is for business purposes; for instance, to manage the accounting for travel expenses associated with a commission sales job.

QUESTION 12. Should I budget surplus expense money?

I’m a salesman and have a daily allocation for expenses. Sometimes I use it all, but other times I have a surplus. Should I budget my expense money with our household budget?

ANSWER: I recommend that you totally separate business expenses and reimbursements from your family budget. Those are business expenses, not related to the family.

Many young salesmen live on their expense accounts and end up with a financial mess on their hands. They charge on their personal credit cards and bill the employer; the employer pays, they spend it, and then the credit card bills come in. That can generate a lot of debt. Therefore, business and personal expenses need to be handled separately. If you end the